COMPREHENSIVE PROPOSAL & CLOSURE WORKFLOW

For Tax Services (CGST, SGST, IGST & VAT)

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Executive Summary

This document outlines a complete, best-in-class workflow for generating tax service proposals and managing project closure. The workflow incorporates CGST, SGST, IGST, and VAT calculations, ensuring compliance with Indian tax regulations while maintaining efficiency through automation and best practices derived from leading platforms like FigsFlow and Microsoft Dynamics 365.

> **Workflow Objectives**
>
> - Automate tax calculations based on service type and client location
> - Ensure 100% compliance with GST/VAT regulations
> - Streamline the proposal-to-closure lifecycle
> - Integrate with existing CRM and accounting systems
> - Provide audit trails and compliance documentation

Phase 1: Pre-Sales - Proposal Generation

Pre-Sales Phase

1

Client & Requirement Intake

Action: Input client information (Name, Contact, GSTIN) and scope of services.
Best Practice: Integrate with CRM (HubSpot/Salesforce) to auto-populate client data, eliminating manual entry errors and ensuring data consistency.

✓ Reduces data entry time by 80%

2

Service Configuration & Pricing

Action: Select services from predefined list (Corporate Tax, VAT Review, R&D Claims).
Best Practice: Use a dynamic Pricing Calculator supporting fixed fees, hourly rates, or hybrid models to protect margins.

✓ Ensures consistent pricing across all proposals

3

Automated Tax Calculation

Action: System automatically applies correct tax based on service type and client location.
Logic Engine:

- **Intra-state:** CGST + SGST (9% + 9%)
- **Inter-state:** IGST (18%)
- **Legacy/International:** VAT as applicable

✓ Eliminates manual calculation errors

4

Compliance & Wording Integration

Action: System pulls latest regulatory wording, disclaimers, and terms.
Best Practice: Maintain an up-to-date library of compliance clauses (GDPR, Making Tax Digital, etc.) for legal soundness.

✓ Ensures all proposals are legally compliant

5

Internal Review & Approval

Action: Draft sent to senior tax partner/compliance officer for review.
Best Practice: Implement digital approval workflow with audit trail before client delivery.

✓ Creates clear accountability and quality control

6

Generation & Delivery

Action: Generate final document and send to client.
Best Practice: Use "living document" links rather than static PDFs for real-time tracking of client engagement.

✓ Provides insights into client interest and engagement

Tax Calculation Matrix

Service Type	Client Location	Tax Type	Rate	Applicable Scenario
Corporate Tax Advisory	Same State	CGST + SGST	9% + 9%	Intra-state supply of services
GST Compliance Review	Different State	IGST	18%	Inter-state supply of services
International Taxation	Outside India	VAT / Export	As per country	Cross-border services
R&D Tax Credit	Same State	CGST + SGST	9% + 9%	Intra-state specialized services
Transfer Pricing	Different State	IGST	18%	Inter-state specialized services

* Rates are indicative and subject to current GST council rates

Phase 2: Post-Sales - Closure Workflow

Post-Sales Phase

1

Digital Sign-off (E-Signature)

Action: Client signs proposal electronically.
Best Practice: Built-in E-Signature compliant with local laws (Electronic Communications Act) makes the proposal legally binding.

✓ Instant conversion from proposal to contract

2

Contract & Project Kick-off

Action: Signed proposal auto-converts to contract; project opens in management system.
Best Practice: Data flows directly to invoicing system - scope, price, and taxes become the "source of truth."

✓ Seamless handoff from sales to delivery

3

Execution & Invoicing

Action: Services delivered; invoices raised per contract terms.
Best Practice: Tax structure from proposal auto-populates invoices for consistency.

✓ Ensures tax compliance throughout billing

4

Administrative Closure

Action: Finalize all deliverables and payments.
Checklist:

- ✓ All milestone reports approved
- ✓ Final payments reconciled
- ✓ Documents archived in cloud repository

✓ Complete audit trail maintained

5

Project Review & Release

Action: Officially close the project.
Tasks:

- Release team resources
- Conduct post-mortem meeting
- Circulate final performance report

✓ Continuous improvement through lessons learned

Project Closure Checklist

Final Closure Verification

- ✓ All deliverables submitted and client approved
- ✓ Final invoice paid and reconciled
- ✓ Tax invoices filed correctly (CGST/SGST/IGST/VAT)
- ✓ All project documentation archived
- ✓ Team resources formally released
- ✓ Post-project review completed
- ✓ Lessons learned documented
- ✓ Client satisfaction survey sent
- ✓ GST returns filed for all applicable invoices
- ✓ Project files moved to long-term storage

Key Features of an Ideal "Best Product"

To support the workflow above, here are the essential features to look for in a software solution:

Multi-Tax Engine

Automatically determines and calculates CGST, SGST, IGST, VAT based on client location and service type, ensuring 100% compliance with current regulations.

Advanced Pricing Calculator

Allows bundling of complex services with different pricing models (fixed/success/hourly) without manual errors, protecting profit margins.

Template & Compliance Library

Stores pre-approved content and automatically updates regulatory wording, ensuring all proposals are compliant and on-brand.

Approval Workflows

Enables senior partners to review and sign off on proposals before sending, creating a clear audit trail and ensuring quality control.

E-Signature & Contract Automation

Turns signed proposals into legally binding contracts instantly, bridging the gap between proposal and closure seamlessly.

CRM & Accounting Integration

Syncs with CRM to pull client data and with accounting software to push invoice details, creating a seamless quote-to-cash flow.

Analytics & Tracking

Tracks when clients view proposals and provides insights into which services are winning the most business for data-driven decisions.

Audit Trail & Compliance

Maintains complete history of all changes, approvals, and versions for regulatory compliance and internal governance.

Implementation Roadmap

Month 1-2: Foundation

- Select and deploy core platform
- Configure tax calculation engine
- Import existing templates

Month 3-4: Integration

- Connect CRM and accounting systems
- Set up approval workflows
- Train team on new processes

Month 5-6: Optimization

- Roll out to all service lines
- Monitor analytics and adjust
- Continuous compliance updates

Important Compliance Notes

- **GST Compliance:** Ensure all proposals clearly mention GSTIN of both parties and HSN/SAC codes for services.
- **Tax Invoice Requirements:** Invoices must include place of supply, reverse charge applicability, and currency for international services.
- **Record Keeping:** Maintain all signed proposals for 6 years as per GST audit requirements.
- **E-invoicing:** For B2B transactions above ₹50 crores turnover, ensure e-invoice compliance.

This document is a comprehensive workflow guide for tax service proposals and closures.
For implementation support or customization, please consult with your tax advisor and IT team.

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